

Cybersecurity Portfolio Projects for 2026 Big Tech Engineering

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1. AI-Agentic Triage and Investigation Engine

Given the shift toward the **"Agentic SOC,"** employers value candidates who can supervise and build autonomous security workflows 3, 4. This project involves creating a system that uses **Large Language Models (LLMs)** to independently execute investigative playbooks, such as pulling identity context, querying SIEM history, and checking EDR telemetry before a human analyst even opens a ticket 5. Your tool should correlate event logs across multiple platforms to construct a unified incident timeline and generate a **natural language summary** for human review 5, 6.

2. "Secure by Design" Cloud Landing Zone with Policy-as-Code

Cloud security is a critical skill for Big Tech, and moving beyond manual configuration is essential 7, 8. Build a multi-cloud landing zone using **Infrastructure as Code (Terraform)** that implements **Zero Trust Architecture** and strict **Least Privilege** principles 9, 10. Integrate automated **policy-as-code** checks (using tools like tfsec or Checkov) that scan the infrastructure before deployment to block risky configurations, such as public storage buckets or overprivileged service accounts 11, 12.

3. IoT Security and Firmware Vulnerability Lab

As the attack surface expands to billions of connected devices, **IoT security** specialists are in high demand 13, 14. Set up a home lab to perform **APK decompilation** and firmware analysis on connected hardware to identify vulnerabilities like unencrypted communication protocols or hardcoded credentials 15, 16. Documenting a full **hardening guide** for a specific hardware target demonstrates the hands-on "builder" mindset that distinguishes security engineers from